

DAY 27: LOWER THE COST OF PET CARE

In a completely different reality, Joseph and I would be living on our own homestead with a few chickens, goats, mini cows, ducks, and at least a couple of rabbits. Obviously, this has yet to happen, because one, the cost, and two, a husband who thinks he will be stuck doing most of the cleanup. And I hate to admit it, but he's probably right!

I guess I'm just as big of an animal lover as the next person—okay, probably a *lot* more—but I do have to say that pets can get pretty expensive. Between food and vet bills, grooming and pet sitting costs, our furry friends deserve their own part of the budget, that's for sure.

Joseph and I have considered adding another rescue bunny to the family, but we know the cost of supplies and possible medical bills will double, and we're not sure we're ready to handle that just yet. We actually fostered an extra rabbit alongside our own for a couple of months when we were first married, and we were shocked at how much more we had to pay for extra supplies!

Plus, in addition to the yearly shots and checkups, as pets get older, they have a higher chance of a medical emergency. We've personally had to make the tough call between an expensive procedure that may or may not work, and giving relief in a different, more humane way.

But a life void of pets is certainly not one I desire to experience, which means the alternative is to cut costs as much as possible. Here are six easy ways to save money on pets, so you can enjoy your playmates and stop worrying about how much you're paying to take care of them:

1. BE PREPARED FOR THE COSTS

With any pet, there are initial costs and maintenance costs, so prepare your budget for both before you go shopping for that little bundle of fur. Grooming, food, and regular checkups are the most important expenses to